

Het Rc Marian Dogmas

het-rc-marian-dogmas

Heterodoxy Marker · Roman Catholicism · doctrine · divided_lineages

DISPUTED

breadth canon-wide

directness direct

variants stable

Statement under examination

Mary, the mother of Jesus, is herself among those redeemed by Christ. She was not preserved from original sin at her own conception, was not bodily assumed at the end of her life, and does not co-mediate the redemption Christ accomplished.

In plain language

This proposition rolls four separate claims about Mary into one statement, and the original-language words behind the cited verses do not speak to all four the same way. In Luke 1:47 Mary calls God 'my savior' (soter mou), which puts her among the people who need to be saved rather than among those who do the saving. Romans 3:23 says 'all sinned' (pantes hemarton), and that all fall short of the glory of God, using a word, 'all' (pantes), that names no exception. First Timothy 2:5 says there is 'one mediator' (heis mesites) between God and people, the man Christ Jesus, and the repeated word for one leaves no room for a second person who shares the mediating work. Hebrews 7:25 reinforces this, saying Christ saves 'completely' (panteles), and 'always' (pantote) lives to intercede, so the saving and the interceding are full and ongoing in him alone. Acts 4:12 adds that there is no other name by which we must be saved. Together these texts press strongly against the ideas that Mary was sinless, that she was taken up by her own merit, and that she helps mediate redemption. The canon also nowhere narrates Mary being taken up bodily, so on that one the words are silent rather than divided. The fourth claim, about whether Mary remained ever virgin, depends on the word 'brother' (adelphos) in Mark 6:3, Matthew 13:55, Acts 1:14, and Galatians 1:19, plus the clause 'until' (heos hou) in Matthew 1:25, and 'firstborn' (prototokos) in Luke 2:7. The default sense of 'brother' (adelphos) is a brother by birth, and koine Greek (the common-era Greek of the New Testament) had a separate word for cousin, 'cousin' (anepsios), attested at Colossians 4:10 but never used for the family of Jesus. That choice carries weight. Still, 'brother' (adelphos) has a wider kin range in some texts, 'until' (heos hou) is on a minority reading non-implicative for what comes after, and 'firstborn' (prototokos) can mark rank as well as birth order. So the words lean toward the denial of perpetual virginity but do not strictly force it. Since the statement asks for all four parts to be accepted together, and one part is genuinely contested on the words alone, the careful reading is that the bundle as a whole is disputed even though three of its parts are decisively supported.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0021	ἀγαλλιάω	agalliao	to rejoice	12
G0079	ἀδελφή	adelphe	sister	26
G0080	ἀδελφός	adelphos	brother	348
G0264	ἁμαρτάνω	hamartano	to sin	44
G0431	ἀνεψιός	anepsios	cousin	1
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	

G1097	γινώσκω	ginosko	to know	222
G1391	δόξα	doxa	glory	
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	367
G1793	ἐντυγχάνω	entugchano	to call on	5
G2087	ἕτερος	heteros	other	
G2193	ἕως	heos	until	147
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G3316	μεσίτης	mesites	mediator	6
G3384	μήτηρ	mētēr	mother	
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	
G3838	παντελής	panteles	completely	2
G3842	πάντοτε	pantote	always	48
G4416	πρωτότοκος	prototokos	firstborn	9
G4773	συγγενής	sungenes	kindred	11
G4990	σωτήρ	soter	savior	24
G4991	σωτηρία	sōtēria	salvation	
G5302	ὑστερέω	hustereo	to lack	16
G5487	χαριτώ	charitoo	to favor	2

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The stem bundles four claims and the canon's vocabulary speaks unevenly to them. Three components are well grounded in the words. In Luke 1:47 Mary calls God 'my savior' (ho soter mou), placing herself in the class of those who require salvation. Romans 3:23 makes 'all sinned' (pantes hemarton) an unrestricted universal in the aorist (a completed past action) with no named exception. First Timothy 2:5 fixes 'one mediator' (heis mesites) between God and people, and Hebrews 7:25 grounds a saving 'to the uttermost' or 'completely' (eis to panteles), with 'always living to intercede' (pantote zon eis to entugchanein), so the mediating role is exclusive and complete in Christ. Acts 4:12 reinforces the exclusivity with 'there is salvation in no other' (ouk estin en allo oudenī he soteria). The fourth component, that Mary did not remain ever virgin, hangs on the semantic range of 'brother' (adelphos) at Matthew 13:55, Mark 6:3, Acts 1:14, and Galatians 1:19, plus the 'until' clause (heos hou) at Matthew 1:25 and 'firstborn' (prototokos) at Luke 2:7. Lexically these data lean toward the stem, but a defensible kinship-semantic reading of 'brother' (adelphos) exists, so this component remains contested on the words alone. Because one of four components is genuinely contested the bundled stem is disputed even though three components are decisively supported.

Scripture

Luke.1.47 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0021 ἀγαλλιάω, G4990 σωτήρ, G2316 θεός

Force. Mary's own words 'my spirit rejoiced on God my savior' (egalliasen to pneuma mou epi to theo to soteri mou). The first-person possessive 'my' (mou) attached to 'savior' (soter) places her in the class of those who require salvation, and the aorist (a completed past action) 'rejoiced' (agalliao) is her own response of joy at a salvation she receives, not one she dispenses, so the verse situates Mary as a recipient inside redemption.

Rom.3.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0264 ἁμαρτάνω, G5302 ὑστερέω, G1391 δόξα

Force. 'All sinned' (pantes hemarton) is an unqualified universal in the aorist (a completed past action), and 'they fall short of the glory of God' (husterountai tes doxas tou theou) is a present middle describing a continuing deficit. The quantifier 'all' (pantes) admits no named exception. On the plain lexical reading the universal includes Mary among those who sinned and fall short, which presses against a preservation from original sin at her conception.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G3316 μεσίτης, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. 'One God, and one mediator between God and people, the man Christ Jesus' (heis theos, heis kai mesites theou kai anthronon, anthropos Christos Iesous). The numeral 'one' (heis) is repeated and applied to 'mediator' (mesites), and the mediating role is grounded in the shared humanity, 'man' (anthropos), of Christ. The singular cardinal forecloses a second mediating party, so the construction excludes any co-mediating function for Mary or any other named human.

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3838 παντελής, G3842 πάντοτε, G1793 ἐντυχάνω

Force. 'To save to the uttermost' or 'completely' (sozein eis to panteles), paired with 'always living to intercede for them' (pantote zon eis to entugchanein huper auton). 'Complete' (panteles) marks the salvation as complete with no remainder for another to supply, and 'always' (pantote) with the present infinitive 'to intercede' (entugchanein) marks the intercession as continuous and his own. The completeness and the permanence leave no mediatorial gap for a co-mediatrix (a female co-mediator) to fill.

Acts.4.12 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G3686 ὄνομα, G2087 ἕτερος, G4991 σωτηρία

Force. 'Salvation is in no other, for there is no other name' (ouk estin en allo oudeni he soteria, oude gar onoma estin heteron). The double negation 'in no one' (oudeni) and 'other' (heteron) with 'name' (onoma) fixes the saving name as singular and exclusive, which on the plain reading rules out a co-saving or co-mediating second party.

Matt.1.25 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G2193 ἕως, G1097 γινώσκω, G4416 πρωτότοκος

Force. 'He did not know her until she bore a son' (ouk eginosken auten heos hou eteken huion), where the verb 'know' (ginosko) is the standard koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) euphemism for marital relations. The clause uses 'until' (heos hou) plus aorist indicative (a simple statement of completed past action), a temporal limit construction whose default reading sets a bound at the birth, after which the negation lapses. The noun 'firstborn' (prototokos) naturally suggests later siblings though it does not strictly require them. Lexically this leans toward the denial of perpetual virginity, but the 'until' idiom (heos hou) is not strictly implicative in every koine sample, so the construction is contested rather than decisive.

Matt.13.55 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0080 ἀδελφός, G3384 μήτηρ

Force. The townspeople name his mother and his 'brothers' (adelphoi) by personal name, 'James and Joseph and Simon and Judas' (Iakobos kai Ioseph kai Simon kai Ioudas). The naming pattern, mother then named brothers, is the standard koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) pattern for siblings of one household. The default sense of 'brother' (adelphos) is biological brother, though the term has an attested wider kinship range.

Matt.13.56 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0079 ἀδελφή

Force. 'Are not all his sisters with us' (hai adelphai autou ouchi pasai pros hemas eisin). The feminine 'sister' (adelphe) has the same primary biological sense as 'brother' (adelphos), and the plural with 'all' (pasai), together with the implication that these women live in the same town as the family, points to ordinary siblings rather than wider kin.

Acts.1.14 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G0080 ἀδελφός, G3384 μήτηρ

Force. 'Mary the mother of Jesus and with his brothers' (Maria he meter tou Iesou kai sun tois adelphois autou). The juxtaposition of 'mother' (meter) and 'brothers' (adelphoi) in one clause, distinguishing the disciples from this household group, is the standard koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) way of naming a nuclear family, which is consistent with biological brothers though not exclusively so.

Gal.1.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0080 ἀδελφός

Force. 'James the brother of the Lord' (Iakobon ton adelphon tou kuriou). The genitive (a noun in the 'of-X' grammatical form) 'the brother of the Lord' (ton adelphon tou kuriou) is the apostolic-letter style of personal identification, and Paul uses 'brother' (adelphos) in the figurative believer sense extensively elsewhere yet here applies it as a personal identifier, which marks this James off from other Jameses by household relation rather than spiritual fellowship.

Col.4.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0431 ἀνεψιός

Force. 'Mark the cousin of Barnabas' (Markos ho anepsios Barnaba). This is the sole New Testament occurrence of 'cousin' (anepsios), but its presence demonstrates that koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) had a distinct word for cousin available. When the gospels and Acts name the family of Jesus with 'brother' (adelphos) and 'sister' (adelphe) rather than 'cousin' (anepsios) or 'relative' (sungenes), the lexical choice has weight on the biological-sibling reading.

Luke.1.28 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key terms. G5487 χαριτώ

Force. 'Rejoice, having been graced, the Lord is with you' (chaire, kecharitomene, ho kurios meta sou). The form 'having been graced' (kecharitomene) is a perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, with the subject receiving the action) of the verb 'to grace' (charitoo), which marks Mary as having received favor that abides in present effect. The verb 'to grace' (charitoo) occurs only twice in the canon, here and Ephesians 1:6, where it describes grace bestowed on all believers in Christ. The participle marks bestowal of grace, not a metaphysical assertion of preservation from original sin.

Mark.6.3 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0080 ἀδελφός, G0079 ἀδελφή

Force. 'The brother of James and Joses and Judas and Simon, and are not his sisters here with us' (ho adelphos Iakobou kai Iosetos kai Iouda kai Simonos, kai ouk eisin hai adelphai autou hode pros hemas). The pericope (passage) names four 'brothers' (adelphoi) by personal name and references 'sisters' (adelphai) resident in the same village. The default sense of 'brother' (adelphos) and 'sister' (adelphe) is biological sibling, but the lexeme (dictionary word) has an attested wider kinship range that a reader can press, which is why this verse alone is taken to leave the perpetual virginity question contested rather than decided.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1Tim.2.5	Deut.6.4	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Job.9.33	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.2.18	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.7.19	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.9.24	tsk	1
Luke.1.47	Luke.2.11	tsk	1
Rom.3.23	Rom.3.9	tsk	1
Matt.1.25	Luke.2.7	openbible	1
Matt.13.55	Mark.6.3	openbible	1
Matt.13.55	Acts.1.14	openbible	1
Gal.1.19	Matt.13.55	openbible	1
Luke.1.28	Eph.1.6	openbible	1
1Tim.2.5	Acts.4.12	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Mark.6.3 · addressed

The hearers list 'brothers' (adelphoi) and 'sisters' (adelphai) of Jesus by personal name. The lexeme (dictionary word) 'brother' (adelphos) has a primary biological-sibling sense but an attested wider kinship range in koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) and Septuagint (the Greek Old Testament) usage, so a reader weighting the wider range can hold the verse compatible with a perpetual virginity claim. The verse is addressed by acknowledging that the term has range, but noting that the gospels and Acts repeatedly choose 'brother' (adelphos) rather than the available distinct words 'cousin' (anepsios) or 'relative' (sungenes) when naming this group, which gives the biological reading the default position without strictly forbidding the wider reading.

Luke.1.28 · addressed

The greeting 'having been graced' (kecharitomene) is a perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, with the subject receiving the action) of the verb 'to grace' (charitoo), marking Mary as a recipient of bestowed grace that has present standing effect. The verb occurs only twice in the canon, here and Ephesians 1:6 where it describes grace bestowed on all believers, so the lexical pattern of 'to grace' (charitoo) is grace given to recipients rather than a metaphysical property predicated of the recipient. The term is resolved as describing bestowed favor, not a constitutional preservation from sin.

Matt.1.25 · addressed

The clause 'he did not know her until she bore' (ouk eginosken auten heos hou eteken) uses 'until' (heos hou) with aorist indicative (a simple statement of completed past action), a temporal limit construction whose default reading places a terminus at the birth. A minority koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) usage of 'until' (heos hou) is non-implicative for the period after the limit, so the construction does not strictly force a change of state after the birth, but the default reading and the presence of 'firstborn' (prototokos) in the same context together lean toward the denial of perpetual virginity.

Luke.2.7 · addressed

'She bore her firstborn son' (eteken ton huion autes ton prototokon). The substantive 'firstborn' (prototokos) can mark first in a series, and elsewhere in the canon it carries the honorific sense of preeminent rank as at Colossians 1:15 and Hebrews 1:6. In a household narrative the natural reading of 'firstborn' (prototokos) is first of more, but the honorific sense is lexically attested, so the term is contested rather than decisive on its own.

Concordance traversed

G4990, G0021, G0264, G5302, G3316, G1520, G1793, G3838, G3842, G2316, G0444, G0080, G0079, G0431, G4773, G5487, G4416, G2193, G1097

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

All cited verses lie outside the published CBGM (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method) scope, which presently covers the 3 John sample only, so variant assessment is shadow. No variant unit at 1 Timothy 2:5, Hebrews 7:25, Luke 1:47, Romans 3:23, Matthew 1:25, Matthew 13:55, Acts 1:14, Galatians 1:19, or Acts 4:12 disturbs 'one mediator' (heis mesites), 'complete' (panteles), 'my savior' (soter mou), 'all sinned' (pantes hemarton), 'until' (heos hou), 'firstborn' (prototokos), 'brother' (adelphos), or 'other name' (onoma heteron).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked

lexical_plain_reading_with_default_senses: supports the denial as a whole, with one component contested · 'My savior' (soter mou), 'all sinned' (pantes hemarton), 'one mediator' (heis mesites), 'complete' (panteles), 'always' (pantote), and 'no other name' (oude onoma heteron) decisively support the redemption, sinlessness, and sole-mediation denials. For perpetual virginity, the default biological sense of 'brother' (adelphos) and 'sister' (adelphe), the 'until' construction (heos hou), 'firstborn' (prototokos), and the availability but non-use of 'cousin' (anepsios) and 'relative' (sungenes) for the Jesus-household relatives together lean toward the denial without quite forcing it.

wider_kinship_semantics_for_adelphos: leaves the perpetual virginity component lexically open · 'Brother' (adelphos) has an attested wider kinship range in koine Greek (common-era Greek of the New Testament) and Septuagint (the Greek Old Testament) usage, 'until' (heos hou) is on a minority but real reading non-implicative for the period after its limit, and 'firstborn' (prototokos) has an honorific sense of preeminent rank attested at Colossians 1:15 and Hebrews 1:6. A reader weighting these ranges can hold the perpetual virginity component undecided on the words alone.

kecharitomene_as_constitutive_grace: does not affect the canon-silence on bodily assumption or on the immaculate conception · A reader can press the perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, with the subject receiving the action) 'having been graced' (kecharitomene) for an enduring graced state, but the verb 'to grace' (charitoo) also occurs at Ephesians 1:6 for grace bestowed on all believers, so the lexical pattern of 'to grace' (charitoo) is bestowal rather than metaphysical constitution. The canon supplies no verse at all narrating Mary's bodily assumption, so on that component the lexical evidence is silence, not contest.

The verdict rests on analogia scripturae (interpreting Scripture by Scripture), reading Luke 1:47 with Romans 3:23 and 1 Timothy 2:5 with Hebrews 7:25 and Acts 4:12. The bundled stem mixes three components with strong lexical

support, one component lexically silent (the canon nowhere reports Mary's bodily assumption), and one component genuinely contested on the semantic range of 'brother' (adelphos) and the 'until' construction (heos hou).

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem is framed descriptively, stating that Mary is among the redeemed, was not preserved at conception, was not bodily assumed, and does not co-mediate. It asserts a position but does not smuggle a tradition-specific taxonomy or a conclusion-bearing definition, so it reads as a testable proposition rather than a preloaded one. The verdict is derived on the original wording.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4990
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3316
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0080
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0431
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5487
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4416
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.3.23
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.1.47
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Tim.2.5
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.7.25
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Mark.6.3
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.1.25
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.13.55
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.1.14
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Gal.1.19
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.4.12
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Col.4.10
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.1.28
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Tim.2.5
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Heb.7.25
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Matt.13.55

License audit

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STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

lexically-disputed · ecm-shadow · cross-tradition-divergent